



SPORTS DEVELOPMENT AUTHORITY OF TAMIL NADU: BUDGET ANNOUNCEMENTS 2025-26: FUELLING THE FUTURE

The Youth Welfare and Sports Development Department of Tamil Nadu along with the Sports Development Authority of Tamil Nadu is proud to unveil its visionary budget for 2025-26, marking a transformative leap to better its previous track records and sustain its position as the sporting powerhouse of the country.

With a strong commitment to propelling athletes towards success and bringing honour to both the state and the nation, this year's budget unveils innovative initiatives aimed at unlocking greater potential, improving infrastructure, and delivering substantial gains for Tamil Nadu on both national and international stages.

Since the honourable Deputy Chief Minister of Tamil Nadu took office in December 2022, under the inspiring leadership of the honourable Chief Minister, the state has made remarkable progress in the field of sports, capturing attention not only throughout India but across the entire Indian subcontinent. While there was a complete overhaul of the existing infrastructure on one hand on a mission mode, new infrastructure was established across the state on the other. The state has also hosted prestigious international events, including the 44th Chess Olympiad 2022, the Asian Hockey Champions Trophy 2023, the World Surfing League QS 3000, the South Asian Junior Athletic Championships 2024, and South Asia's first-ever Formula 4 Street Night Race, earning its reputation as the "Sporting Capital of India."

Building on this impressive momentum, the Budget Announcements for 2025-26 aim to elevate Tamil Nadu's standing in the sports arena even further. With a record allocation, this budget outlines a comprehensive strategy to maintain Tamil Nadu's position as a national sports leader.

INFRASTRUCTURE: BLUEPRINT FOR SPORTING EXCELLENCE

Tamil Nadu has taken significant strides in establishing itself as a frontrunner in developing cutting-edge sports infrastructure, setting a high standard for excellence nationwide. The state's para-athletes have been achieving remarkable feats, consistently winning medals in both national and international arenas. To further nurture and support emerging talent, the Budget has proposed the creation of dedicated Para Sports Arenas in five more districts. This initiative builds on the existing facilities in five districts currently under development, offering enhanced training opportunities for para-athletes to excel.

In a noteworthy effort to boost sports at the grassroots throughout Tamil Nadu, plans are underway to construct Mini Stadia in every Assembly Constituency. This initiative, fuelled by a vision for increased accessibility to sports facilities, has already made headway in constituencies that previously lacked such facilities. A total of 40 Mini Stadia are slated for construction across 40 Assembly Constituencies



at a total cost of Rs 120 crore. These Mini Stadia are designed to provide local communities with improved access to sports facilities, catering to a variety of athletic events while encouraging community participation thereby fostering a culture of health and wellness within the region.

Additionally, Salem and Ramanathapuram will soon benefit from a state-of-the-art Synthetic Athletic Turf, complete with a top-quality football field and dedicated jumps and throwing sector. Meanwhile, the Swimming Pool within the Aquatic Gymnastics Badminton (AGB) Complex in Velachery is set for a significant upgrade to meet Olympic standards.